

Postmortem: Partial ACH Load Caused Two Days of Under-Alerting

Postmortem ID: PM-2026-0522 | Incident date 2026-05-22 (detected 2026-05-26) | Severity: Sev-1 | Feed: ACH_DAILY

Summary

The ACH_DAILY file for 2026-05-22 was truncated in transit. The Glue job loaded 61% of the records and reported success. The following business day's load hit S3 throttling and the automatic Glue retry left a partial partition. Sentinel TM scored incomplete ACH data for two business days.

Timeline (US Eastern)

Time	Event
2026-05-22 03:10	ACH_DAILY lands truncated (trailer record missing); Glue job loads 61% of records and succeeds.
2026-05-26 03:40	S3 SlowDown errors; Glue auto-retry completes with a partial partition.
2026-05-26 11:00	FCC Operations notices ACH alert volume down about 40% versus trend.
2026-05-26 11:30	Sev-1 declared; Priya Raman, Tom Kessler, Elena Brooks and Dana Whitfield engaged.
2026-05-26 16:00	Treasury Operations re-sends both files; reloaded and reconciled.
2026-05-28	Lookback run for both business dates completed.

Impact

Two business days of ACH transactions were under-scored. The lookback run generated 38 alerts retroactively, 2 of which were escalated to L2.

Root Cause

Row-count and hash-total reconciliation against the trailer record was only implemented for WIRE_DAILY, so the truncated ACH file and the partial retry were not caught at load time.

Resolution

Both files were re-sent by Treasury Operations and reloaded. A lookback run covered 2026-05-22 and 2026-05-26 within 3 business days as required by NWB-POL-101 section 6. The BSA/AML Officer was notified in writing.

Runbook Adherence

Not followed. Missing step: **step 6** (reconcile row counts and hash totals against the trailer record) - it was not run for the ACH feed. Runbook v4.0 now states reconciliation applies to every feed.

Action Items

#	Action	Owner	Status
1	Extend trailer reconciliation to all feeds as a blocking check	Data Platform Eng	Done
2	Update NWB-RB-401 to v4.0 clarifying step 6 applies to every feed	Priya Raman	Done
3	Add per-feed record-volume anomaly detection	FCC Risk Analytics	In progress